

Figure 4: Setting up the Sequence Editor

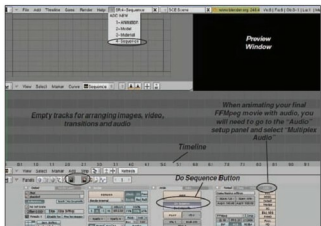


Figure 5: Video Sequence Editor workspace

general movie-making purposes, the effect you should be concerned about is Crossfade.

That's it! You are good to go with your movie. Preview it, save it or discard it; the choice is yours.

Basics of the game engine

One of the most outstanding plus points of Blender is its Game Engine (known to the geek community as Real-Time Animation Features). The engine combines physics and logic blocks with animation. You can add/decrease gravity, specify force and friction, etc. In addition, though some level of programming skills in Python are wonderful, they are not necessarily required to work with the Game Engine.

Before going any further, you need to set up the Game Engine. Navigate to the *Shading and World Buttons*. Under the *Mist/Stars/Physics* tab, set the engine to *Bullet*. You may specify the *Gravity* at this junction, though usually, the default settings will suffice.

Next, move the cursor into the 3D window, and press *P*. Click the *Add* button under *Sensors, Controllers and Actuators*. Once you change the sensor from *Always* to *Keyboard*, you will see a block for *Key*. Click in that box, and type the key you want to use. For instance, you can tie a force to the 'Up' arrow,



Figure 6: Setting up the Game Engine

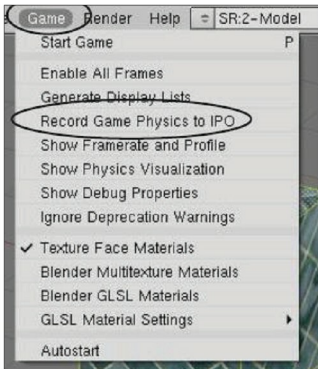


Figure 7: Turning on Game Physics

so that when pressed, the sphere moves forward.

The next step is to deal with physics. Just head to the *Game* pull-down menu, and select the *Record Game Physics to IPO* option. Hit *P* to run the action, and use *Esc* to exit. The action will be written, and will henceforth run via *Alt+A*.

Tip: Remember to turn off the *Record Game Physics to IPO* button; else, it will make a new curve every time you hit *Play*.

Well, that ends the short voyage we embarked on to cover recent innovations in Blender. This series of *Let's Try* is helpful when viewed in the light of Blender-related articles published in earlier issues of *LINUX For You*. Hope you enjoyed it! 

By: Sufyan bin Uzayr

Sufyan is a 19-year old technology enthusiast with a passion for music, philosophy, theology and sports. Currently pursuing his Bachelor's degree, he also freelances as a writer, photographer and graphics artist. He can be reached at <http://www.sufyan.co.nr>